INDIA TODAY
www.indiatoday.in

CHAIRMAN AND EDITOR-IN-CHIEF: Aroon Purie
VICE CHAIRPERSON AND EXECUTIVE EDITOR-IN-CHIEF: Kalli Purie
GROUP CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER: Dinesh Bhatia

GROUP EDITORIAL DIRECTOR: Raj Chengappa

CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER: Manoj Sharma

GROUP CREATIVE EDITOR & CHIEF OF AI : Nilanjan Das **GROUP PHOTO EDITOR:** Bandeep Singh
EDITOR (FEATURES): Kai Jabir Friese
MANAGING EDITORS: Sunil Menon, S. Sahaya Ranjit, Manisha Saroop, Kaushik Deka
MUMBAI: M.G. Arun
SENIOR DEPUTY EDITORS: Anilesh S. Mahajan, Sangram K. Parhi, Sasi Nair
DEPUTY EDITORS: Pradip R. Sagar; JAIPUR: Rohit Parihar; MUMBAI: Suhani Singh
SENIOR EDITORS: Sonali Acharjee, Ashish Mukherjee, Saikat Niyogi
PATNA: Amitabh Srivastava; BHOPAL: Rahul Noronha;
Hyderabad: Prasad Nichenametla
SENIOR ASSOCIATE EDITORS: Sonal Khetarpal
MUMBAI: Dhaval S . Kulkarni; AHMEDABAD: Jumana Shah
ASSOCIATE EDITOR: Avishek G. Dastidar, Vipul Grover; BENGALURU: Ajay Sukumaran
ASSISTANT EDITOR: KOLKATA: Arkamoy Datta Majumdar
PRINCIPAL CORRESPONDENT: LUCKNOW: Avaneesh Mishra
SUB EDITOR: Udbhav Seth
PHOTO DEPARTMENT: Chandra Deep Kumar (Deputy Chief Photographer),
Arun Kumar (Principal Photographer)
MUMBAI: Mandar Suresh Deodhar (Chief Photographer)
PHOTO RESEARCHERS: Prabhakar Tiwari (Deputy Visual Research Editor),
Saloni Vaid (Chief Photo Researcher),
Jodha Singh Adhikari (Principal Photo Researcher)
GRAPHICS EDITOR: Tanmoy Chakraborty
ART DEPARTMENT: Sanjay Piplani (Creative Editor),
Angshuman De (Senior Art Director), Rajesh Kumar Angira, Bhoomesh Dutt Sharma (Associate Art Directors), Santosh Kumar Sharma (Assistant Art Director), Praveen Kumar Gummadi (Chief Designer),
Siddhant Jumde (Chief Illustrator)
PRODUCTION DEPARTMENT: Harish Agarwal (Chief of Production),
Naveen Gupta (Chief Coordinator)

CHIEF OPERATING OFFICER
Suparna Kumar

IMPACT TEAM
Senior General Managers: Jitendra Lad (West and East), Syed Naveed (Chennai)
General Manager: Mohan Bisht (North)
Deputy General Manager: Raghunandan P (Bengaluru)
GROUP CHIEF MARKETING OFFICER: Vivek Malhotra

SALES AND OPERATIONS
Deepak Bhatt, Assistant Vice President-Sales and Distribution
Rajeev Gandhi, General Manager (North)
Yogesh Godhanlal Gautam, Regional Sales Manager (West)
Manawer Hossain, Regional Sales Manager (East)

Volume 51-Number 25; For the week
June 23-29, 2026, published on every Friday

• Editorial/Corporate Office Living Media India Ltd., India Today Group Mediaplex, FC-8, Sector-16A, Film City, Noida - 201301; Phone: 0120-4807100 • Subscriptions: For assistance, contact, email: wecare@intoday.com; Phone / Whatsapp: +91 8597 778 778 (Monday to Saturday, 9.30am – 5.30pm). • Sales: Direct all trade enquiries to General Manager (Sales), Living Media India Limited, C-9, Sector-10, Noida-201301 (UP). • Regd. Office: F-26, First Floor, Connaught Place, New Delhi-110001. • Impact Offices: 1201, 12th Floor, Tower 2 A, One World Centre, (Jupiter Mills), S.B. Marg, Lower Parel (West), Mumbai-400013; Phone: 022 69193355; Fax: 66063226 • E-1, Ground Floor, Videocon Towers, Jhandewalan Extn, New Delhi. • Door No: 610, 610A, 612, 5th Floor, Block A, Imperial Chaitanya Building, Anna Salai, Teynampet, Chennai, Tamilnadu-600018. • 201-204 Richmond Towers, 2nd Floor, 12, Richmond Road, Bangalore-560025; Phones: 22212448, 22213037, 22218343; Fax: 22218335; • 52, Jawaharlal Nehru Road, 4th Floor, Kolkata-700071; Phones: 22825398; Fax: 22827254; • 6-3-885/7/B, Somajiguda, Hyderabad-500082; Phone: 23401657, 23400479, 23410100, 23402481, 23410982, 23411498; Fax: 23403484 • 39/1045, Karakkatt Road, Kochi 682016; Phones: 2377057, 2377058 ; Fax: 2377059 • 2/C, "Suryarath Bldg", 2nd Floor, Behind White House, Panchwati, Office C.G. Road, Ahmedabad-380006; Phone: 26560393, 26560929; Fax: 26565293 • Copyright Living Media India Ltd. All rights reserved throughout the world. Reproduction in any manner is prohibited.
Printed and published by Manoj Sharma on behalf of Living Media India Limited. Printed at Thomson Press India Private Limited, 18-35 Milestone, Delhi Mathura Road, Faridabad-121007, (Haryana) and at Rajhans Enterprises, 134, Industrial Town, 4th Main Road, Rajajinagar, Bengaluru-560044, (Karnataka).

Published at F-26, First Floor, Connaught Place, New Delhi-110001.

Editor: Raj Chengappa.

• INDIA TODAY does not take the responsibility for returning unsolicited publication material.

All disputes are subject to the exclusive jurisdiction of competent courts and forums in Delhi/New Delhi only

For **reprint rights** and **syndication** enquiries, contact syndications@intoday.com or call +91-120-4078000
www.syndicationstoday.in

CONTENTS

UPFRONT: BJP'S QUEST FOR TWO-THIRDS PG 8

STATESCAN: PUNJAB'S CRISIS OF AUTHORITY PG 20



30 COVER STORY

WHY WE ARE EATING OUR FOREIGN EXCHANGE

The Iran war exposes India's dependence on imported pulses, fertilisers and edible oils, with the expense set to soar to $56 billion or 6 per cent of total imports. What we need to do to achieve food self-sufficiency

Photo illustration by **BANDEEP SINGH / AI**

▶ **FIGHTER JETS**

42 Seeking 6th-Gen Company

India wants to join a sixth-gen fighter project—the next leap in aerial combat

▶ **RAJASTHAN**

48 A Leaky JJM Pipeline

Fudged tenders, contracts, and vested interests converge in a Rs 979 cr. scam

▶ **REGIONAL CINEMA**

54 New Northeast Wave

Powerful films from the region finally get attention in India and abroad

▶ **LEISURE**

59 Family Saga

Karan Mahajan's *The Complex* sets a '70s Delhi family against a changing nation

Note to the reader

From time to time, you will see pages titled 'An Impact Feature' or 'Focus' in INDIA TODAY. These are no different from advertisements, and the magazine's editorial staff is not involved in their creation in any way.

Cover by **NILANJAN DAS / AI**

Readers are recommended to make appropriate enquiries before sending money, incurring expenses or entering into commitments in relation to any advertisement appearing in this publication. The India Today Group does not vouch for any claims made by the advertisers of products and services. The printer, publisher, editor-in-chief and the editor of the India Today Group publications shall not be held liable for any consequences in the event of such claims not being honoured by the advertisers.

SCAN HERE TO SUBSCRIBE

FOR SUBSCRIPTION ASSISTANCE, CONTACT:
email: wecare@intoday.com | Phone / Whatsapp: +91 8597 778 778
(Monday to Saturday, 9.30am – 5.30pm)

E-MAIL to:
letters.editor@intoday.com or
log on to **www.indiatoday.in**